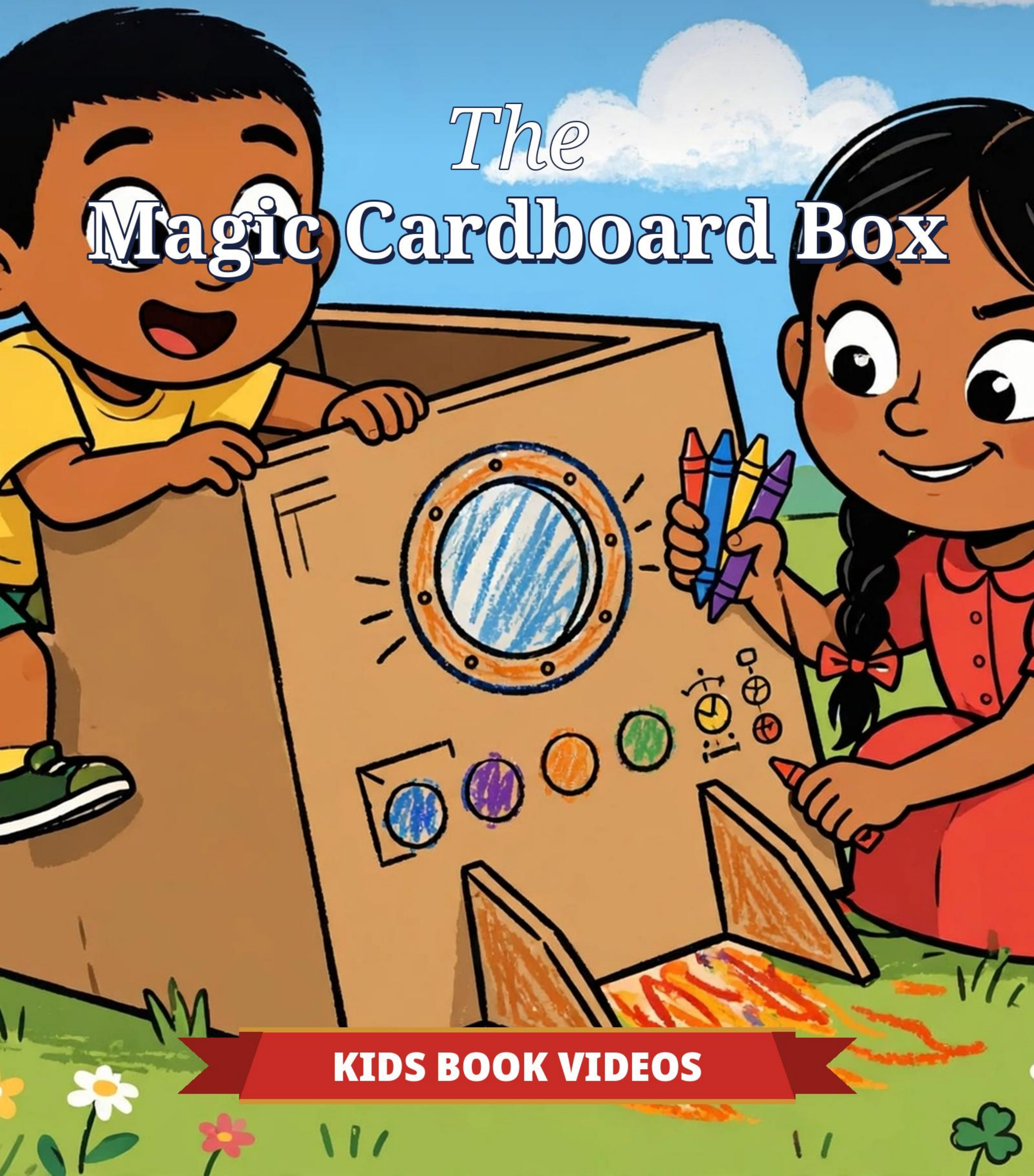


Bedtime Tales

The Magic Cardboard Box



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



A big cardboard box arrived at Dara's house. It had held a new lamp, and now it was empty. Dara climbed inside. "It is just a box," he said, a little bored.

Then his sister Zoya had an idea. "What if it is not just a box?" she whispered, her eyes gleaming with mischief. She drew a round window on the side, then buttons and dials. "It is a rocket!" she declared.



Dara's eyes went wide. "Five, four, three, two, one," they counted together. "Blast off!"

They zoomed to the moon and waved at the stars. "Again, again, again!" shouted Dara, bouncing with thrill — three times he shouted it.



Then Zoya flipped the box over and drew a steering wheel. "It is a race car now!" she announced. Vroom, vroom, went Dara, racing around the living room. He won the big race, and his chest puffed up with pride.

Then their mama joined in.



She cut a door in the box.



"It is a cozy house," she said.



Dara and Zoya crawled inside, and Mama brought cushions.



They had a picnic in the box house — yum, yum, went their pretend sandwiches — and Dara's tummy glowed with happiness.



One box had been three things. A rocket. A race car. A cozy house. "What will it be tomorrow?" asked Dara. "Anything," said Zoya. "Anything, anything, anything," she sang — three times she sang it. Dara's jaw dropped. A box could be anything!



As evening came, Dara curled up in the box house. It was small and warm, and it smelled like cardboard and crayons. He yawned. Zoya yawned too. Mama covered them with a blanket.



Sleep now, little dreamers. Dream of boxes that become anything at all.

The best toys, little one, are the
ones your imagination builds.

The End

